

Tuesday, 22 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 25° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 23° 17°	MANCHESTER Overcast 21° 16°	GLASGOW Drizzle 18° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Airlines are furious after a second air traffic control glitch in a short space of time caused more widespread disruption for travellers.

EasyJet said the latest incident 'once again calls into question the resilience' of the system. Passengers faced significant delays and cancellations across the UK and Europe.

TRAVEL · UK
- 2

The first UK charges have been brought in connection with the 1994 Rwanda genocide, almost 30 years after the horrific events.

Dr Vincent Brown, formerly Dr Vincent Bajinya, is due to appear in court today. He faces seven charges related to the genocide, which saw an estimated 800,000 people killed.

JUSTICE · UK
- 3

Specialist courts for rape cases are set to be rolled out across England and Wales, aiming to improve the experience for victims.

The government says new funding will allow victims to view proceedings remotely. They will also be able to give evidence from a separate room via video link, hopefully making the process less daunting.

JUSTICE · UK
- 4

A man has been charged with causing death by dangerous driving following a devastating crash that killed six people in 2024.

Four members of the same family and a married couple on a motorbike died in the collision. The charges bring some progress in a case that shocked the local community.

JUSTICE · UK
- 5

Tragic news from the Northumberland coast, where two pilot whales have died after a mass stranding.

Despite efforts to refloat them, the tides made it impossible to save the whales. It's always heartbreaking to see these beautiful creatures in distress.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Good news for fans of 'The Other Bennet Sister' – the first look at the Christmas special has been revealed!**
 Filming wrapped on the festive episode back in October, and anticipation has been building ever since. It promises to be a delightful addition to the Christmas TV schedule.
ON AIR – Are you excited for more period drama this Christmas, or do you prefer something more modern?
 TV · CHRISTMAS
- 2 Hollywood stars Ryan Reynolds and Rob McElhenney have added another Wrexham landmark to their portfolio, buying the historic Turf pub!**
 The pub is a regular feature on their Disney+ documentary 'Welcome to Wrexham'. It's great to see them investing further in the club and the local community.
ON AIR – If you owned a football club, what's the first thing you'd buy for the fans?
 TV · ONGOING
- 3 The mysterious Scouse rapper EsDeeKid had an 'insane' set at All Points East, leaving fans buzzing even though his identity remains a secret.**
 Despite not knowing who he really is, music lovers seem to be embracing the enigma. It just proves that good music speaks for itself!
ON AIR – Does knowing an artist's identity matter to you, or is it all about the music?
 MUSIC · ONGOING
- 4 Strictly Come Dancing is back with a brand new hosting trio as the celebrities discover their dance pairings!**
 Emma Willis, Josh Widdicombe, and Johannes Radebe are taking over the reins. It's always an exciting moment when we find out who's dancing with whom.
ON AIR – Who are you most excited to see on the dancefloor this year, and do you think the new hosts will be a hit?
 TV · AUTUMN
- 5 Scottish DJ Calvin Harris has been recognised for a truly incredible world record – playing to a crowd of 1.6 million people!**
 The massive attendance was at his set in Sao Paulo, Brazil, earlier this year. It's an astonishing number and a testament to his global appeal.
ON AIR – What's the biggest crowd you've ever been part of, either at a concert or a sporting event?
 MUSIC · ONGOING

On the schedule

1 **Five key players, including Cole Palmer and Declan Rice, have withdrawn from the England squad ahead of their Nations League matches.**

Tino Livramento, Kobbie Mainoo, and Marcus Rashford have also pulled out. It means Gareth Southgate will have to make some significant adjustments to his team.

ON AIR – With so many players out, who do you think deserves a chance to step up for England?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **It looks like Cardiff is set to win the race to host the highly anticipated boxing match between Tyson Fury and Anthony Joshua!**

The Welsh capital is reportedly beating out competition from London and New York. This would be a massive event for the city and for British boxing fans.

ON AIR – If the fight comes to Cardiff, would you be heading there, or watching from home?

BOXING · UK

3 **Great Britain's Billie Jean King Cup team are planning an upset against the all-star Czech Republic today.**

They face a huge challenge in the Finals, but the team is determined not to be underestimated. It promises to be a thrilling encounter for tennis fans.

ON AIR – Do you think GB can pull off a surprise win against the Czechs today?

TENNIS · UK

4 **Formula 1 has announced a change for the 2027 season, reducing the maximum distance of Grand Prix races by 15 kilometres.**

The new maximum distance will be 290km, down from 305km. It's a small but significant tweak to the rules, which could impact race strategy.

ON AIR – Do you think this change will make F1 races more exciting, or does it not make much difference?

F1 · FUTURE

5 **Jordan James insists a depleted Wales squad will have no fear as they face Portugal in their Nations League opener.**

They'll be up against 'the best players in the world' on Thursday, but James says they won't be overawed. It's a tough test, but Wales are ready for the challenge.

ON AIR – Can Wales cause an upset against Portugal, despite missing some key players?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 British gardeners are finding new joy in growing 'micro-vegetables' on their windowsills and balconies.**
This trend involves cultivating miniature versions of popular veggies like carrots and radishes, perfect for small spaces and adding a fresh crunch to any meal.
- 2 A fascinating study suggests that 'listening to bird song' each morning can significantly boost mood and reduce daily stress.**
Researchers found that even a few minutes of listening to the natural chorus helps to create a calm start to the day, improving overall well-being.
- 3 The humble 'board game cafe' is seeing a resurgence across the UK, offering a nostalgic alternative to screen time.**
These friendly spots provide a cosy atmosphere for friends and families to gather, reconnect, and enjoy classic and new board games over a cuppa.
- 4 Experts are encouraging us to rediscover the simple pleasure of 'writing a shopping list on paper'.**
Apparently, the physical act of writing helps memory retention and often leads to fewer impulse purchases than digital lists, making for more mindful shopping.
- 5 A new appreciation for 'vintage radio plays' is growing, with many finding comfort in storytelling without screens.**
Streaming platforms and community groups are seeing increased interest in classic audio dramas, offering a captivating way to unwind and engage the imagination.
- 6 Families are embracing the 'staycation challenge' of exploring local historical sites right on their doorstep.**
This initiative encourages people to uncover hidden gems and fascinating stories in their own towns and counties, making for affordable and enriching outings.
- 7 The delightful art of 'flower pressing' is making a charming comeback as a creative hobby.**
People are rediscovering how to preserve beautiful blooms to create unique art, greeting cards, and thoughtful gifts, connecting with nature's beauty.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of bread will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GOOD SQUEEZE, OF COURSE!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of coffee, especially if it's a special blend. What is it?

ANSWER: TAKING A REALLY BIG, APPRECIATIVE SNIFF OF THE AROMA FIRST!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular quirky habit' you picked up as a child, perhaps from a parent or grandparent, has just stuck with you into adulthood?
Whether it's how you butter your toast, or a specific way of tidying up, what's that one charmingly odd routine you still do that makes you think of your younger days?
- We all have that 'one small, everyday item' that, despite its humble nature, you've somehow managed to keep for years and years, and it still works perfectly?
Perhaps it's a trusty old mug, a reliable bottle opener, or a favourite pen. What's that surprisingly long-lasting item in your home that has truly stood the test of time?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Did you know that the traditional British red pillar box was originally painted green when first introduced in 1852?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first ever recorded 'selfie' was taken by an ancient Egyptian pharaoh using a highly polished copper shield.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the bubonic plague by destroying the rat-infested timber houses.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament', which seems rather fitting for such wise-looking birds.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to sense the flavour of leaves and nectar.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The sound of Big Ben's chimes is officially known as the 'Westminster Quarters'.
- The famous 'Keep Calm and Carry On' posters were originally printed by the British government in 1939 but rarely used.
- Tardigrades, also known as 'water bears', are microscopic animals that can survive in extreme conditions, including outer space.
- Queen Victoria sent the first ever Royal Christmas card in 1843.

On this day

Day 265 of the year, 100 days left in 2026. Today American Business Women's Day (United States); Baltic Unity Day (Lithuania, Latvia); Christian feast days: Digna and Emerita; Christian feast days: Emmeram of Regensburg. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1937 — Don Rutherford, English rugby player (died 2016)
- 1981 — Ashley Eckstein, American actress
- 1987 — Teyonah Parris, American actress
- 1930 — Joni James, American singer (died 2022)
- 1974 — Jenn Colella, American actress and singer
- 1982 — Billie Piper, English actress and singer
- 1933 — Leonardo Balada, Spanish-American composer and educator
- 1967 — Matt Besser, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1976 — Red Dye No. 4 is banned by the US Food and Drug Administration after it is discovered that it causes tumors in the bladders of dogs.
- 2006 — Twenty-three people were killed in a maglev train collision in Lathen, Germany.
- 1979 — A bright flash, resembling the detonation of a nuclear weapon, is observed near the Prince Edward Islands. Its cause is never determined.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1991 — The Dead Sea Scrolls are made available to the public for the first time.
- 1966 — Twenty-four people are killed when Ansett-ANA Flight 149 crashes in Winton, Queensland, Australia.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1934 — The Gresford disaster in Wales kills 266 miners and rescuers.
- 1980 — Iraq invades Iran, sparking the nearly eight year Iran–Iraq War.

- **1965 — The Indo-Pakistani War of 1965 between India and Pakistan over Kashmir ends after the United Nations calls for a ceasefire and after a last engagement near Dograi.**

A peek at tomorrow

Day 266 of the year, 99 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Adomnán; Christian feast day: Blessed Bernardyna Maria Jabłońska; Christian feast day: Cissa of Crowland (or of Northumbria); Christian feast day: Blessed Elena Duglioli. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1949 — Bruce Springsteen, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1945 — Paul Petersen, American actor, singer, author, and activist
- 1985 — Cush Jumbo, British actress
- 1958 — Danielle Dax, English singer-songwriter and producer
- 1957 — Rosalind Chao, American actress
- 1978 — Anthony Mackie, American actor
- 1959 — Frank Cottrell-Boyce, English author and screenwriter
- 1947 — Mary Kay Place, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1932 — Saudi National Day: Crown Prince (later king) Faisal of Saudi Arabia, on behalf of Ibn Saud, proclaims the unification of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, the current iteration of the Third Saudi State.
- 1947 — A magnitude 6.9 earthquake strikes South Khorasan in Iran, killing over 500 people.
- 1962 — Flying Tiger Line Flight 923, a Lockheed L-1049H Super Constellation registered as N6923C, ditches into the Atlantic Ocean killing 28 out the 76 occupants onboard. The remaining 48 were rescued six hours later.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2022 — Voting begins in the five-day sham annexation referendums in Russian-occupied Ukraine, leading to Russian annexation of Donetsk, Kherson, Luhansk and Zaporizhzhia oblasts.
- 1955 — An all-white jury in Mississippi finds Roy Bryant and J. W. Milam not guilty in the torture-murder of 14-year-old African American boy Emmett Till.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar